



Stop clicking, start prompting!

Visual Studio Code and Agentic AI for Power Platform builders

Nick Doelman • Microsoft MVP & MCT



Irish
Power Platform
Summit

About your speaker



Nick Doelman

I help companies build and adopt intelligent business solutions.

Microsoft MVP (8x) · MCT · Solution architect · Trainer · Advisor
15+ years on Dataverse, Power Pages and model-driven apps



Microsoft MVP (8x)



Power Platform BOOST



Canada Powerlifting

nickdoelman.com

Blog, sessions, podcast and everything I publish. All of it lives there.

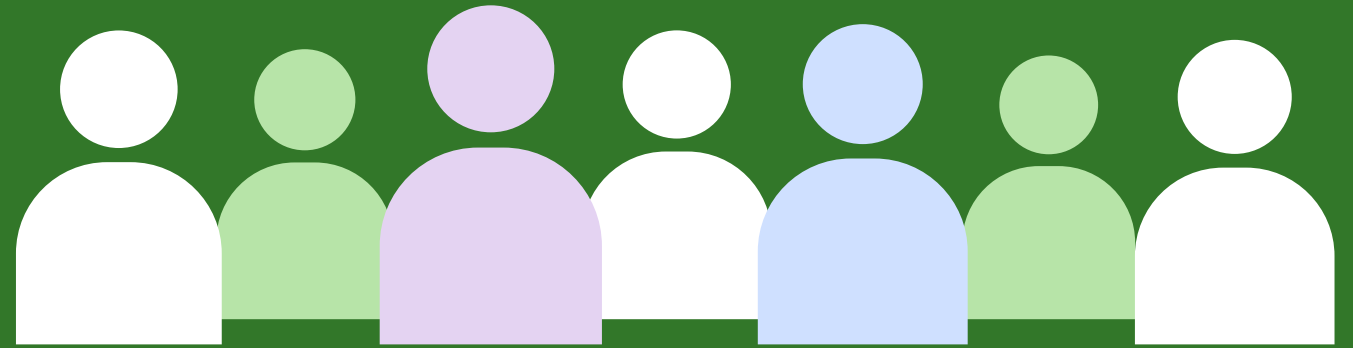
readyxrm.blog · [ReadyBMS](#) · [Ottawa](#)

Takeaways

- 1 Visual Studio Code, set up right
- 2 Agents that plan and self-check
- 3 Dataverse and Power Platform skills
- 4 A ticketing app, built by prompt
- 5 Where it saves time, where it bites

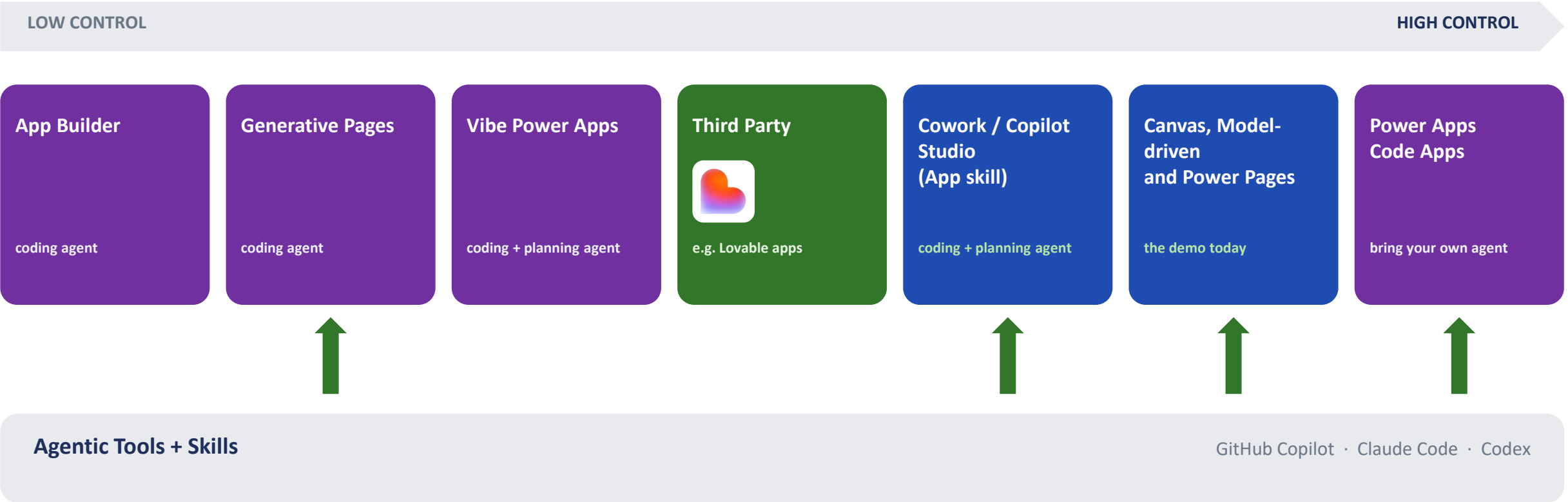
Stop clicking, start prompting!

Visual Studio Code and Agentic AI for Power Platform builders



Everyone can build apps now.

AI-assisted development in Power Platform and Microsoft 365



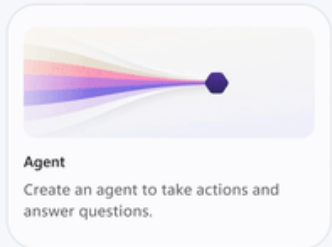
Same skills, same workflow. What changes is how much of the result you own.



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Preview: building apps in Cowork and Copilot

Hey



Describe it. The platform builds it.

There is a second path being built, and it is not the one in this session.

Plain language in, a working agent or app out.

Governance is in the platform

Not a set of constructs you assemble yourself afterwards.

Lifecycle comes with it

Publishing, sharing and versioning come with the surface.

Built for AI apps first

Agents, actions and grounding are the primitives, not a retrofit.

Microsoft Copilot Managed Runtime

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Copilot Managed Runtime blog post page. At the top, the Microsoft logo is followed by the Copilot logo and navigation links: Products and features, Solutions, Plans and pricing, Resources, Open Copilot, and Download the app. On the right, there are links for Sign in, ME, Light, and Dark. The main heading of the blog post is "Build where you want, run with confidence: Now Microsoft hosts and manages the code created by Copilot", dated September 25, with a 5-minute read time. The author is David Blyth, Vice President and General Manager, Managed Apps and Agents. Below the heading is a video player with a play button and a progress bar showing 0:00 / 0:00 at 1x speed. To the right of the video is a diagram titled "Copilot Managed Runtime Host" showing a grid of nine icons, each representing a managed runtime environment. Below the video player are social sharing icons (Share, Facebook, X, LinkedIn) and a "CONTENT TYPES" section with buttons for "Feature releases" and "News". The "TOPICS" section is partially visible at the bottom.

Microsoft | Copilot Products and features Solutions Plans and pricing Resources Open Copilot Download the app Sign in ME Light Dark

Blog home > Build where you want, run with confidence: Now Microsoft hosts and manages the code created by Copilot Search the blog

Feature releases • September 25 • 5 min read

Build where you want, run with confidence: Now Microsoft hosts and manages the code created by Copilot

By David Blyth, Vice President and General Manager, Managed Apps and Agents

Listen to this post

0:00 / 0:00 1X

SHARE

Code is becoming easier for anyone to create with AI. Apps in Copilot Cowork and the new Copilot Code experience bring that creation directly into Copilot, helping people move from an idea to working apps and code in the same place they already get work done.

Functioning code is only the first step. The work that follows includes provisioning and securing cloud resources, configuring identity and security

CONTENT TYPES

Feature releases News

TOPICS

Microsoft Copilot Managed Runtime

Very early preview

It is moving fast and it is not finished. What you see in a demo today is not what ships.

Consumption licensing

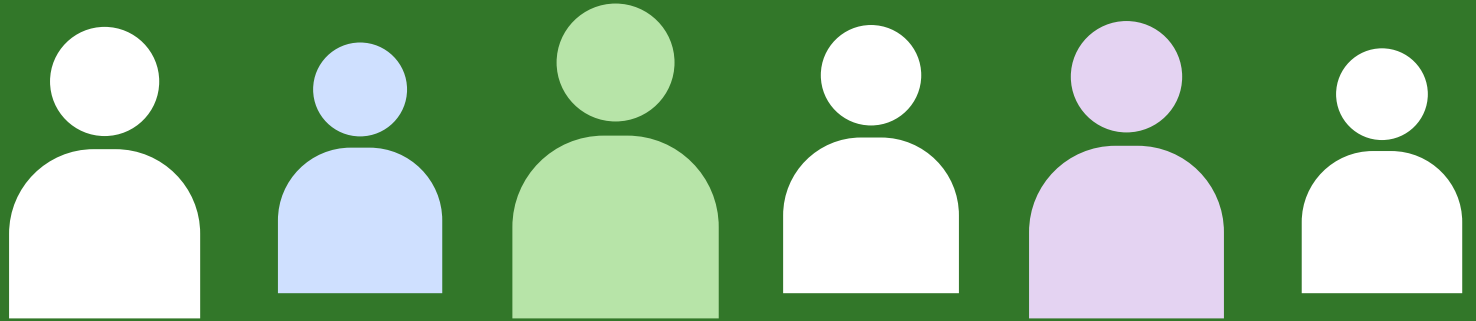
Priced on what it consumes rather than per user. Whether the market accepts that is an open question.

Not solution-aware

No solutions. It is Git-driven, versioned and promoted the way traditional source control works, not the Power Platform constructs you know.

So we build here today

Dataverse, solutions, environments. The thing you can hand to somebody else and support.



Visual Studio Code is a maker tool

You are already a developer

THE OBJECTION

Visual Studio Code is a developer tool.

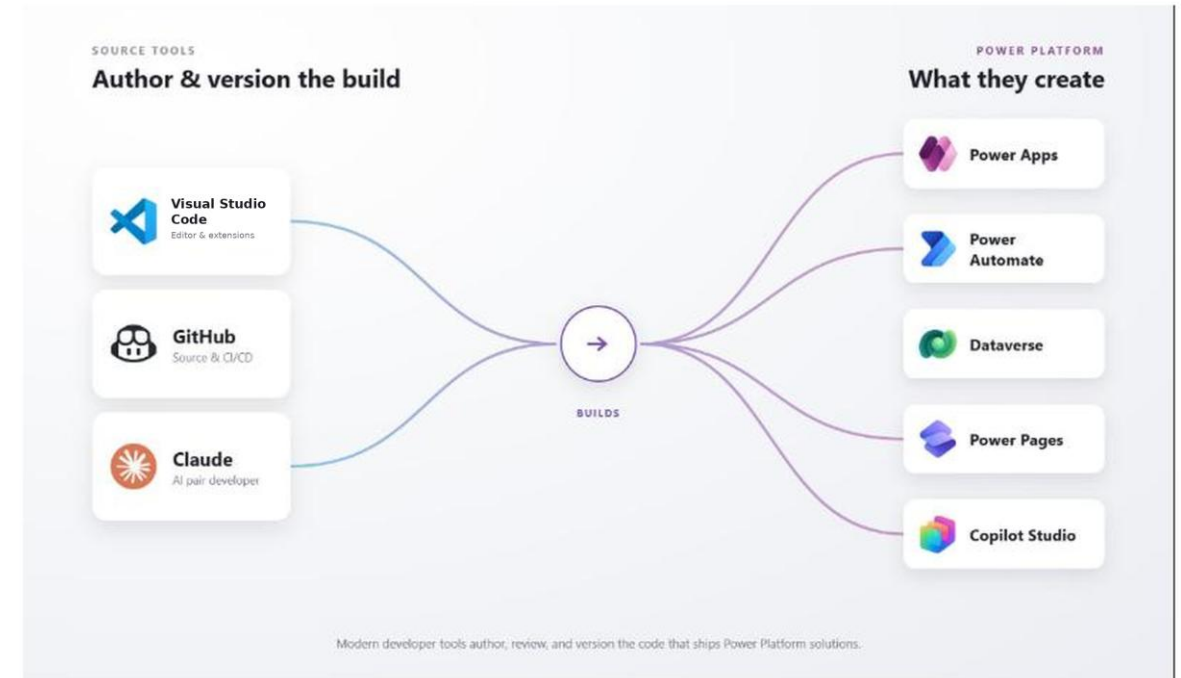
I am just a maker. The command line frightens me.

THE ANSWER

If you build applications, you are as much a developer as anyone.

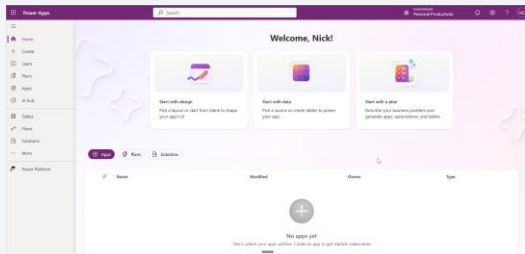
Visual Studio Code is a text editor with extensions. Treat it as a maker tool.

And the best form of low code is natural language, which is what developers have been chasing for decades.



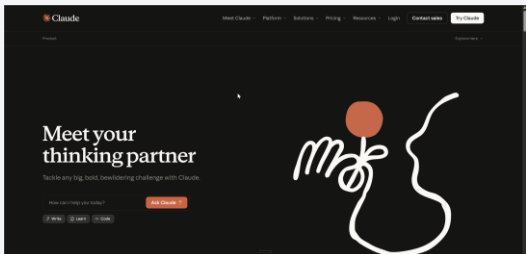
The same tools, pointed at the Power Platform.

What you need before you start



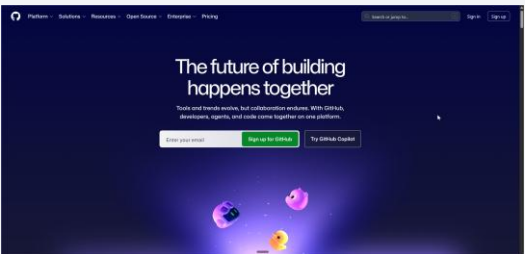
A Power Platform tenant

Nothing here replaces it. You still need an environment to build in.



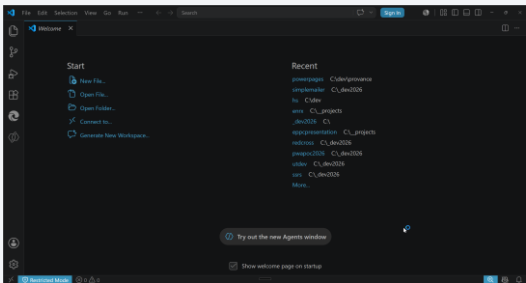
An agentic coding tool

Claude Code today. GitHub Copilot or Codex work the same way.



A GitHub account

Free is fine. This is where you save progress and track history.



Visual Studio Code

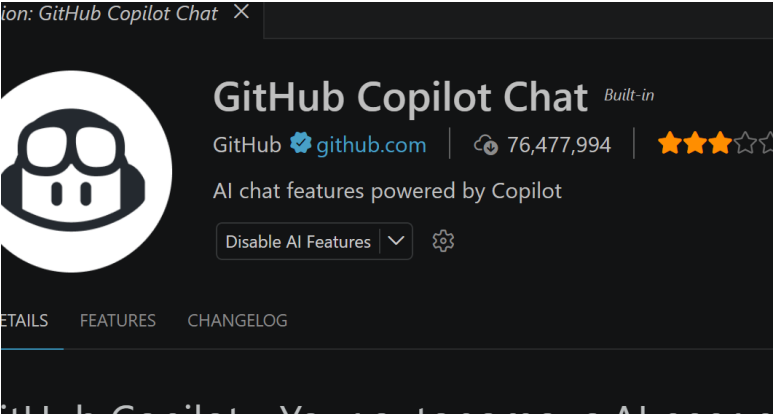
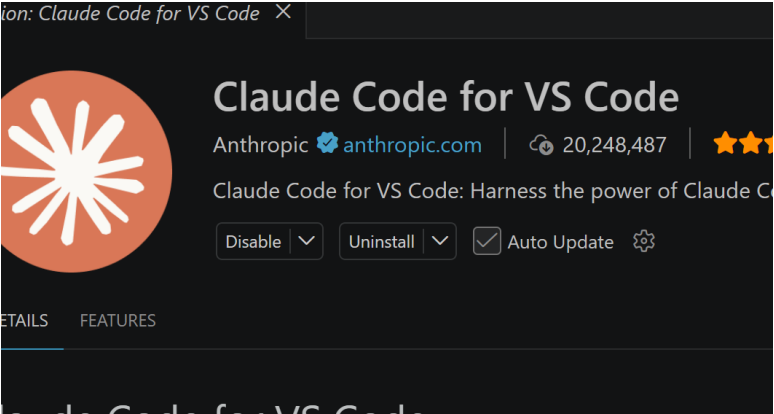
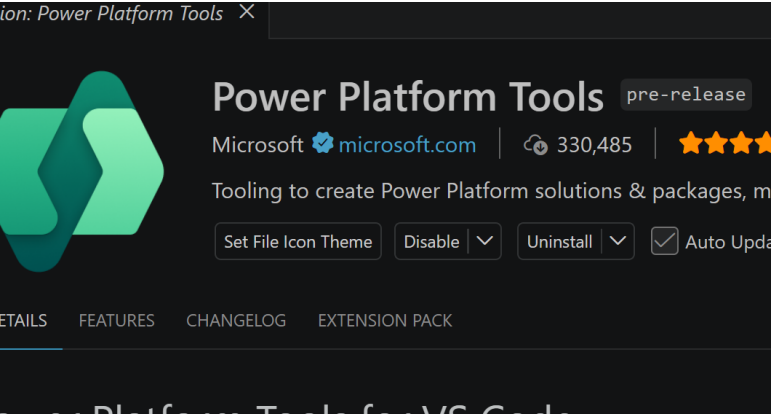
Free from Microsoft. Windows, Mac and Linux. The hub for the rest.

Four sign-ups and one download. That is the barrier to entry.

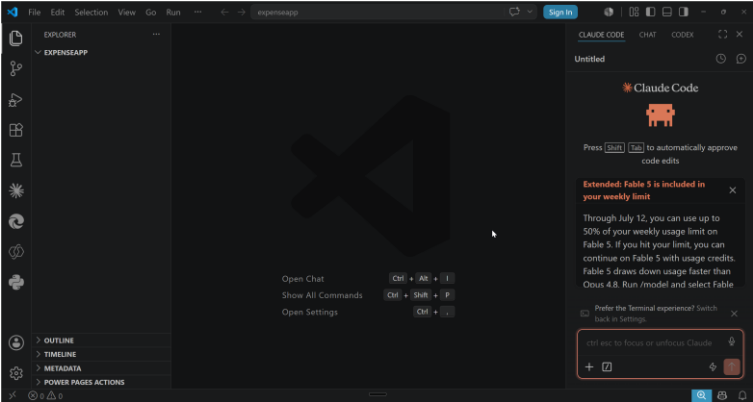


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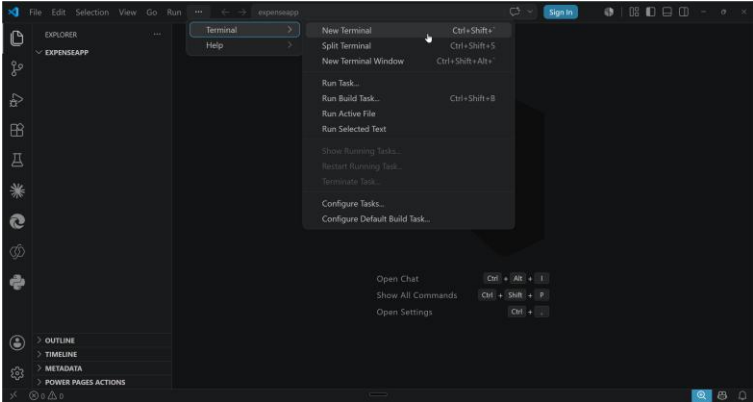
Three extensions to start



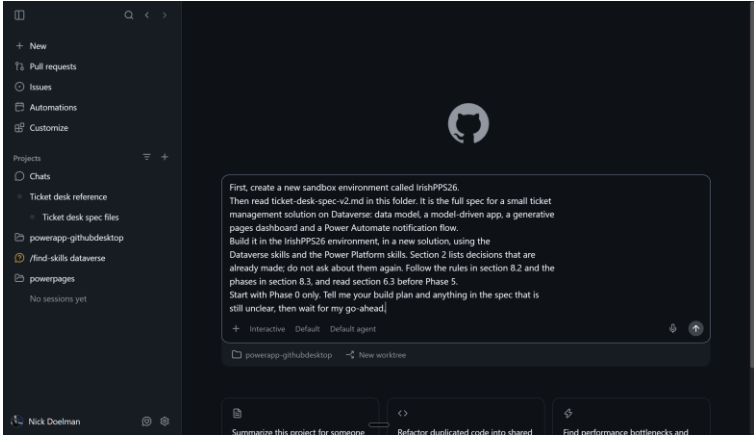
Side panel, terminal or desktop agent app



Side panel



Terminal



Desktop agent app

Pick the harness you like

Claude Code

Terminal or Visual Studio Code, on an Anthropic subscription. Driving the demo today.

GitHub Copilot

Same workflow, same skills, inside Visual Studio Code on a GitHub subscription.

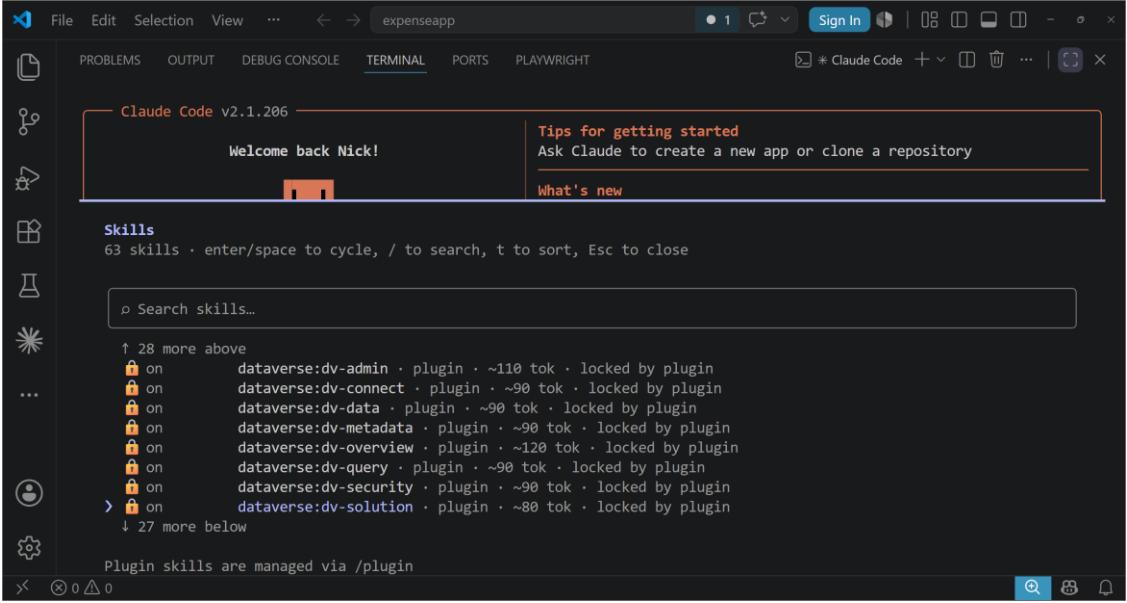
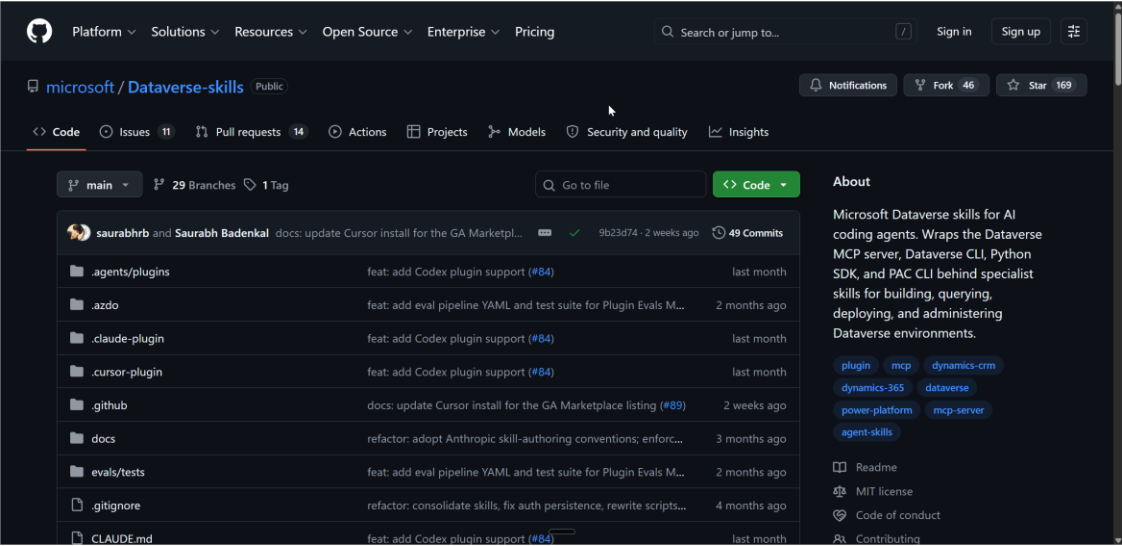
Codex

OpenAI's agent, in the editor or the terminal. Same loop, same shape of work.

The point

Harnesses and models change every few months. The workflow does not. That is what to learn.

Install the Dataverse skills



What the skills wrap

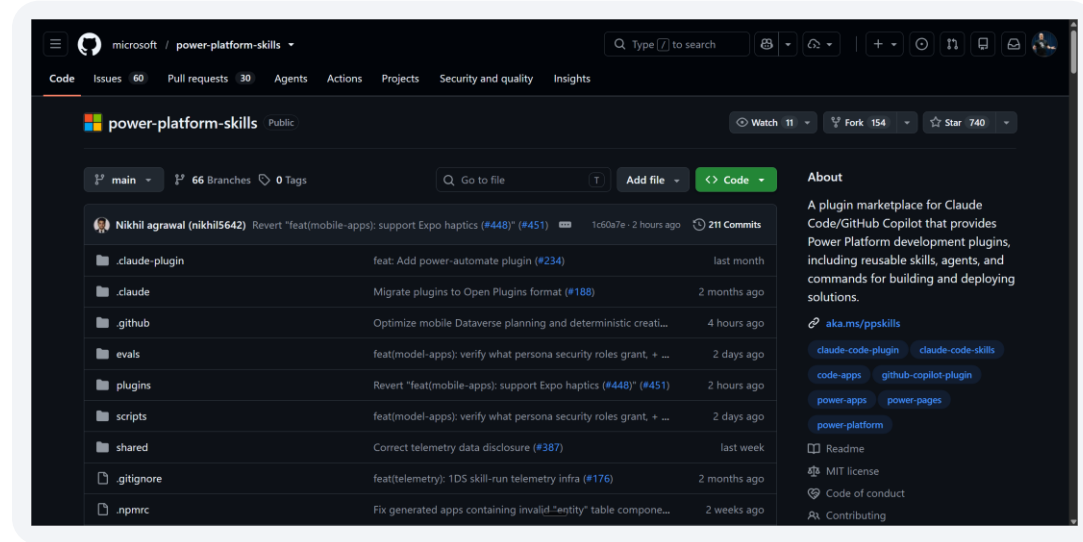
One install, three tools

- microsoft/Dataverse-skills on GitHub.
- Wraps the Dataverse MCP server, the Dataverse CLI and the PAC CLI.
- Install commands for Claude Code and GitHub Copilot are both in the README.

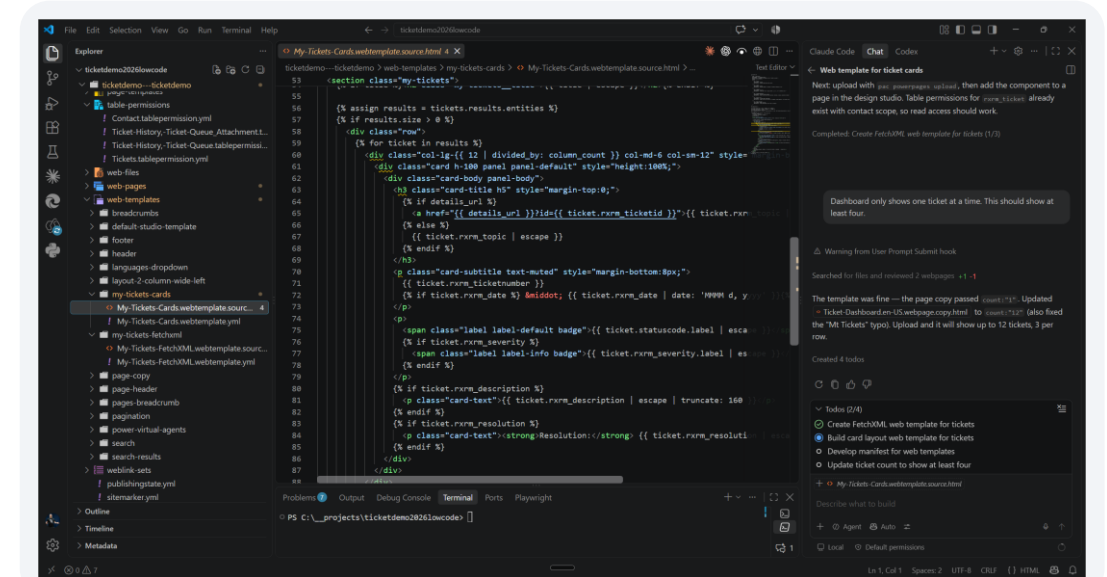
What lands in your project

- dv-connect, dv-metadata, dv-solution, dv-data, dv-query, dv-security, dv-admin and more.
- An .env file with your environment URL, tenant ID and the MCP client ID it enabled for you.
- Microsoft Learn and Dataverse MCP servers, wired in.

And the Power Platform skills



microsoft/power-platform-skills. One installer script.



Web templates and Liquid still respond well to an agent.

What they build

Generative pages, model-driven and Canvas apps, flows, Power Pages code sites.

Where to get them

github.com/microsoft/power-platform-skills.
One script, then reload.

The gap today

No skill yet for traditional low-code Power Pages sites.

You are not stuck

Liquid, JavaScript, the Web API, web pages and web templates.

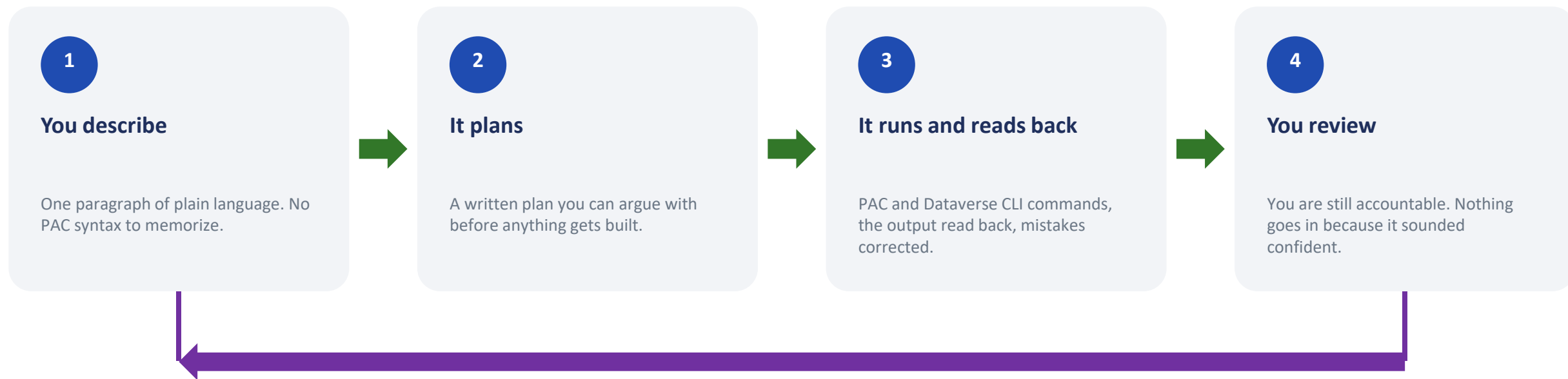


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Agentic, not autocomplete

The loop is the point

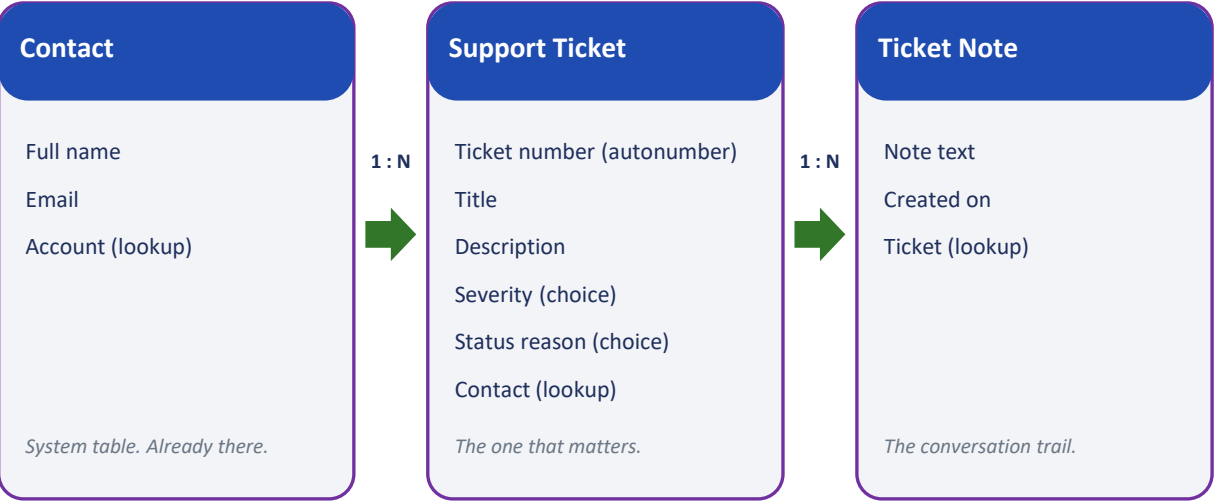


Then round again, with what the last lap taught it. That second lap is where the quality comes from.

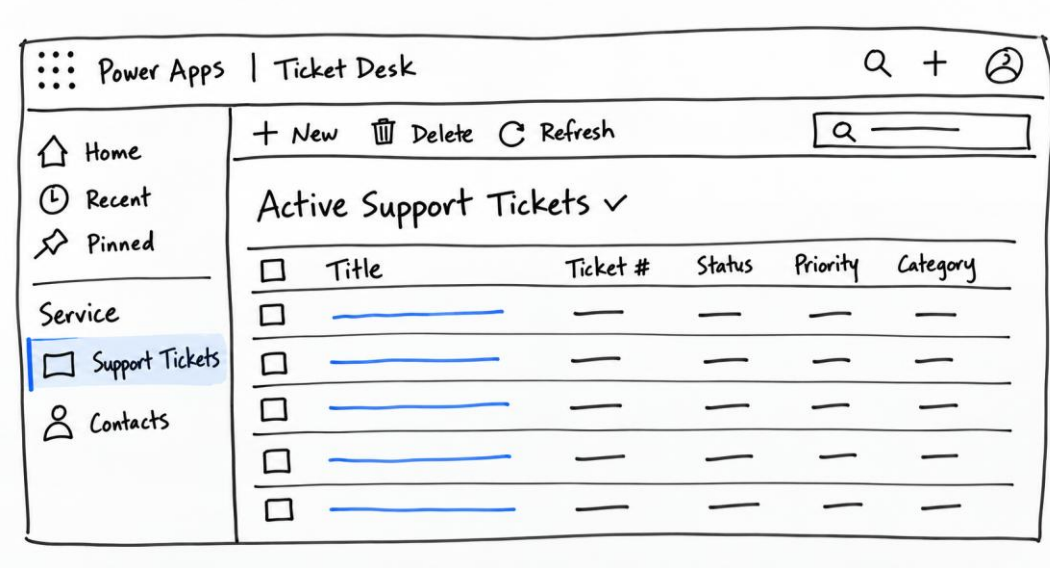


Let's build it

Design phase



The data model



The app, sketched

Three habits that pay you back

01

Write the instructions down

Run /init once and keep a CLAUDE.md in the project. Prefixes, conventions, the things you do not want to explain twice. The agent reads it every session.

02

Ask for a changelog

Have it append to changelog.md as it works. It turns a black box into a reviewable diff, and it is the only record of why something was built that way.

03

Plan first, keep the prompt

Use the plan skill before you build. When it works, ask the agent to write the prompt it wishes it had on day one. That file is the artifact, not the code.

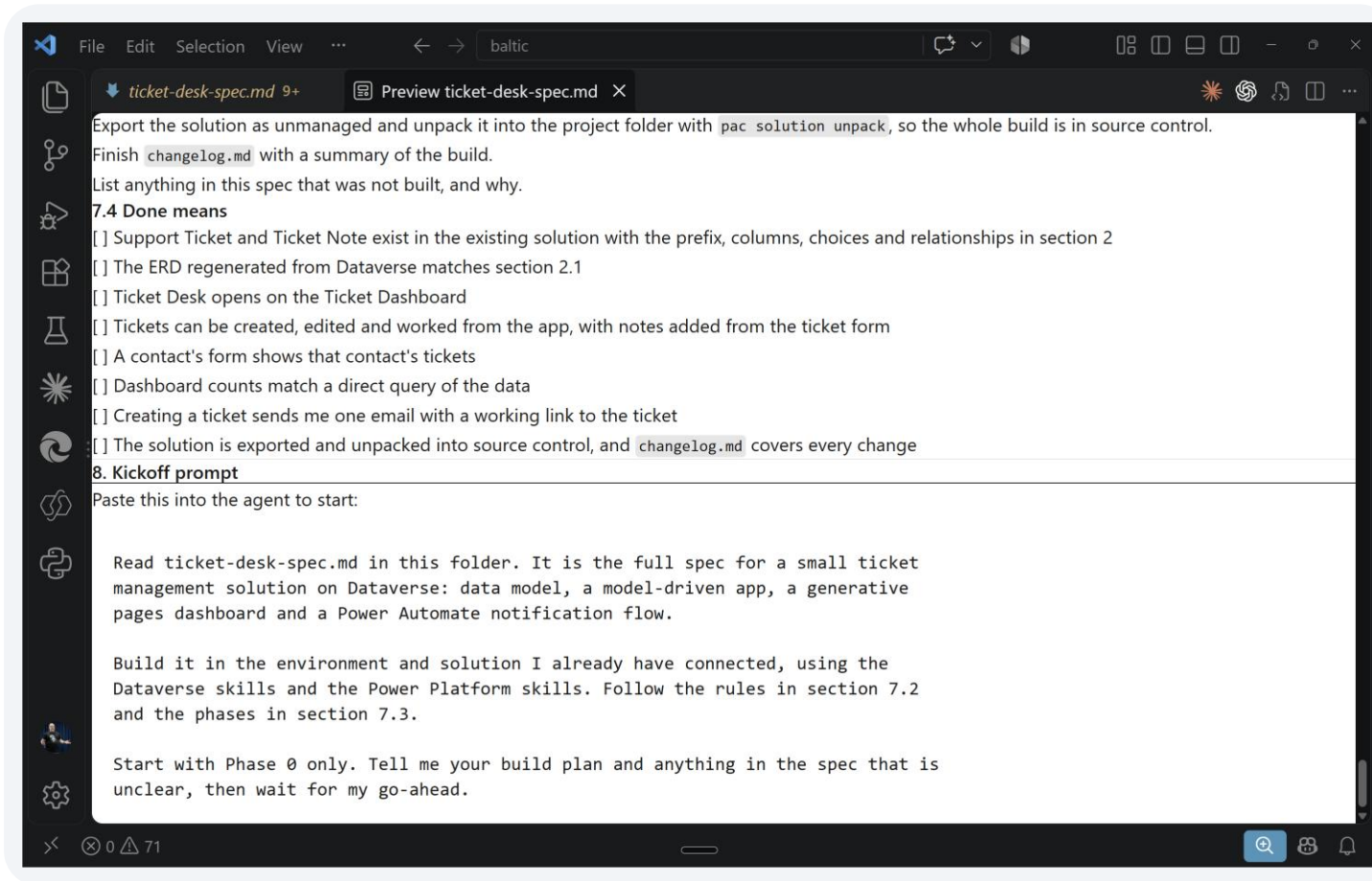
Slides and
the project



[github.com/readyxrm/
irishsummit2026](https://github.com/readyxrm/irishsummit2026)

*Who here has always wanted to go back and rebuild something they already shipped?
The code was always the cheap part. Keep the spec and the rebuild is an afternoon.*

Create spec



The screenshot shows the Visual Studio Code interface with a file named `ticket-desk-spec.md` open. The file content includes instructions for exporting a solution, a checklist of requirements, and a kickoff prompt. The checklist items are:

- [] Support Ticket and Ticket Note exist in the existing solution with the prefix, columns, choices and relationships in section 2
- [] The ERD regenerated from Dataverse matches section 2.1
- [] Ticket Desk opens on the Ticket Dashboard
- [] Tickets can be created, edited and worked from the app, with notes added from the ticket form
- [] A contact's form shows that contact's tickets
- [] Dashboard counts match a direct query of the data
- [] Creating a ticket sends me one email with a working link to the ticket
- [] The solution is exported and unpacked into source control, and `changelog.md` covers every change

The **8. Kickoff prompt** section contains the following text:

Paste this into the agent to start:

Read ticket-desk-spec.md in this folder. It is the full spec for a small ticket management solution on Dataverse: data model, a model-driven app, a generative pages dashboard and a Power Automate notification flow.

Build it in the environment and solution I already have connected, using the Dataverse skills and the Power Platform skills. Follow the rules in section 7.2 and the phases in section 7.3.

Start with Phase 0 only. Tell me your build plan and anything in the spec that is unclear, then wait for my go-ahead.

FOR REFERENCE

One markdown file. Tables, columns, relationships, an ERD, the build phases, a done-means checklist and a kickoff prompt at the end.

This is the page you review. Not ten thousand lines of generated code.

ticket-desk-spec.md, open in Visual Studio Code.

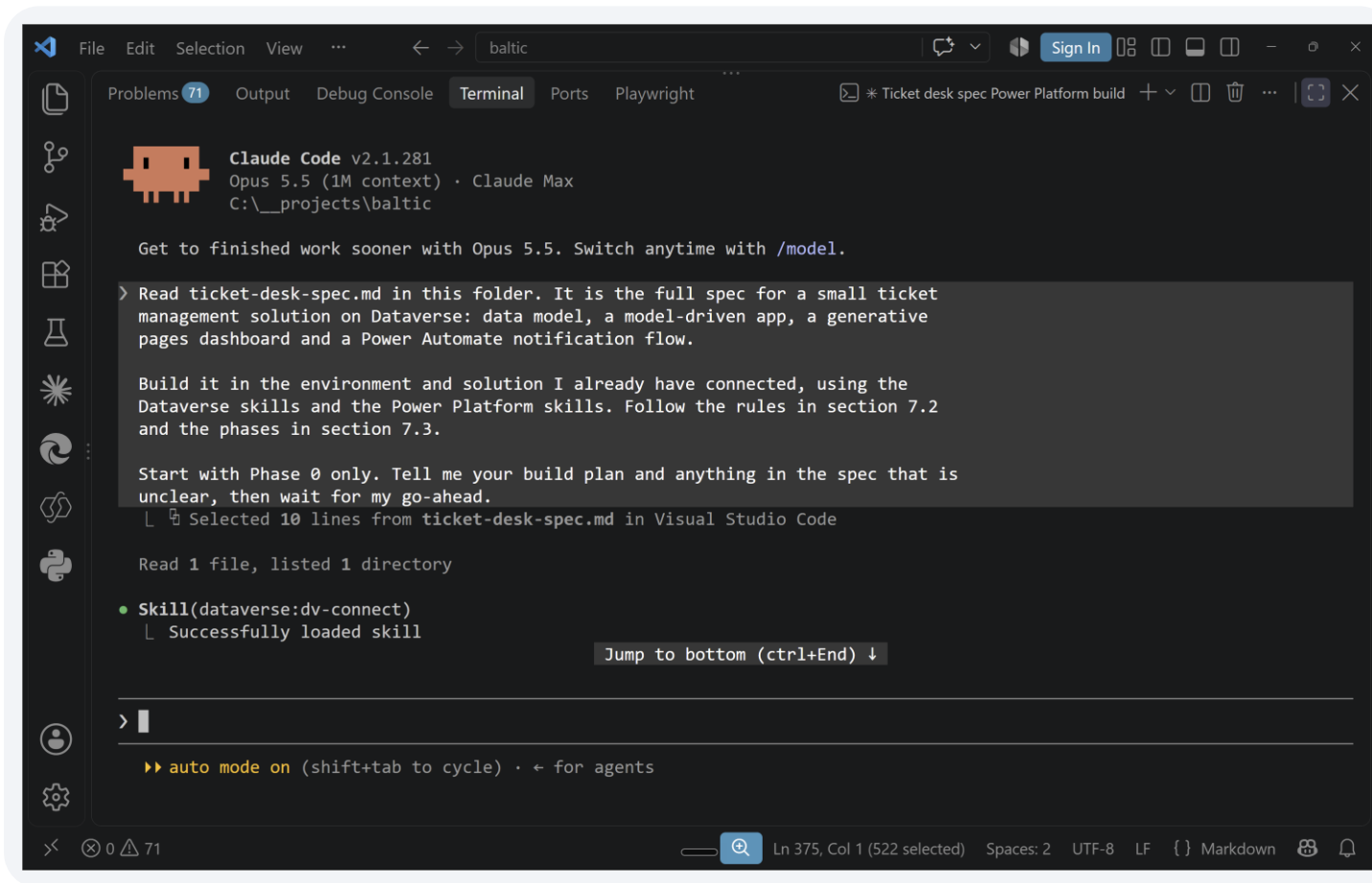
The build demo

- 1 Environment, from one prompt
- 2 Auth profile, workspace, MCP server
- 3 Solution and publisher, prefix tkt
- 4 Tables, relations and sample data
- 5 A model-driven app on top

Ticket Desk

Contact, Support Ticket, Ticket Note.
One spec, one prompt.

Step 3: hand it to the agent



FOR REFERENCE

Paste the kickoff prompt into Claude Code in the Visual Studio Code terminal. It reads the spec and loads the Dataverse skills.

Phase 0 only. It comes back with a build plan and its questions before it touches the environment.

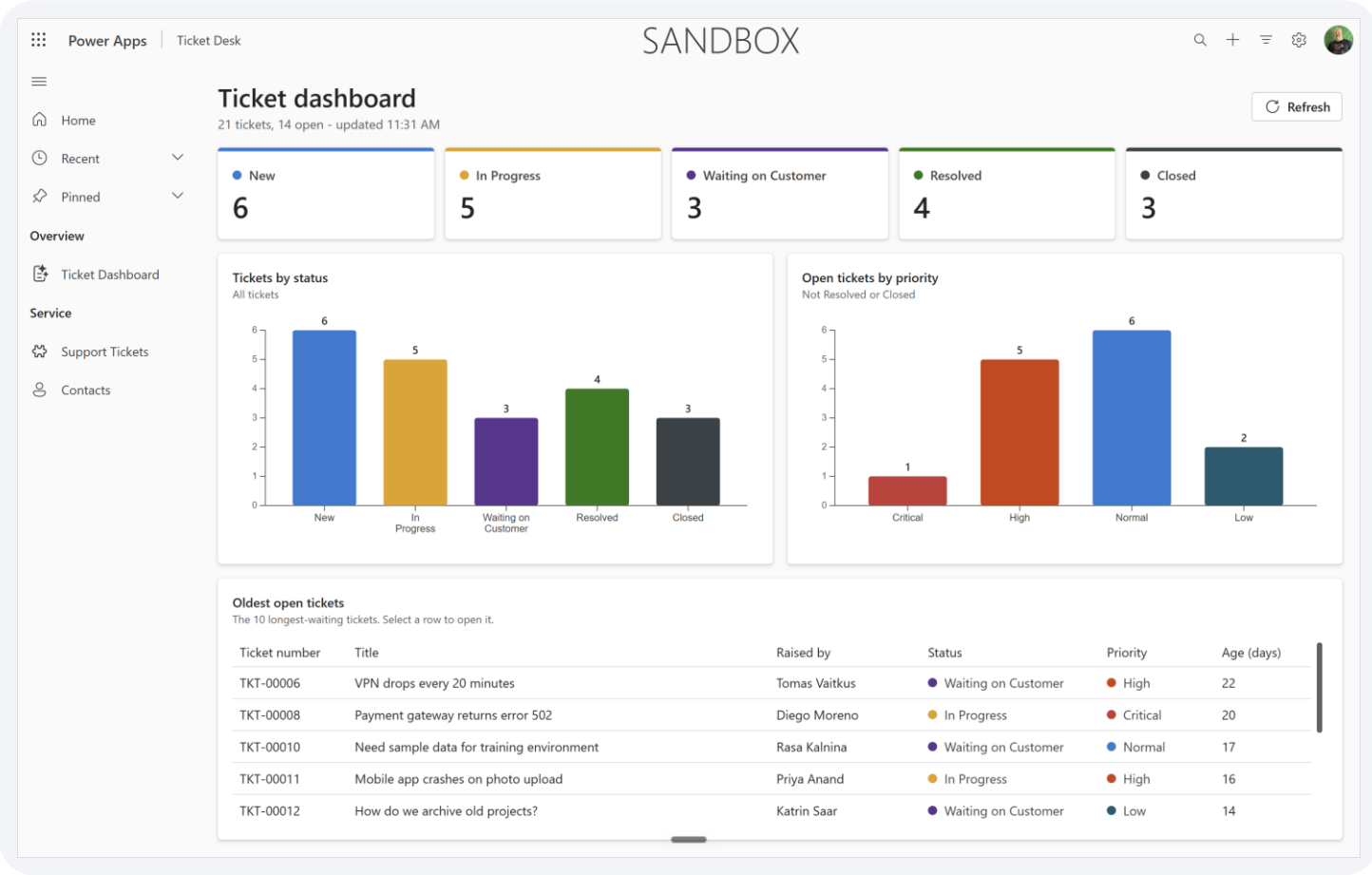
The prompt came out of the spec. Nothing was retyped.

DEMO



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Step 4: what came out



FOR REFERENCE

Ticket Desk, a model-driven app with a generative pages dashboard on the Dataverse tables from the spec.

Status counts, open tickets by priority, and the oldest open tickets in a list you can click through.

Built from one spec and one prompt, in the environment we set up earlier.

Where it bites



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Watch for these

It fills in your blanks

I asked for amounts and got decimal columns instead of currency. It caught it and reworked. Say it up front.

Approve every command

Early on, watch what it runs so you learn the process. Automate it later, not first.

Security is still yours

Table permissions and roles do not get a pass because an agent wrote them. Check them yourself.

It is keen

It will happily build the whole app before you asked. One step at a time until you trust it.

“This is a tool. It is not a replacement for knowing your craft.”

Nick Doelman

Do this on Monday

Install three things

Visual Studio Code, Power Platform Tools, and the agent you already pay for.

Install the skills

One command from the microsoft/Dataaverse-skills repo. Then ask it to list your tables.

Draw the model first

Tables, columns, choices, relationships. On paper. Then hand it over.

Build something real

A ticketing app, an expense app, anything with a user. An hour of this beats any deck.

Take this with you

Read and watch

- readyxrm.blog/2026/07/16/ditch-the-power-apps-maker-portal/
- youtu.be/uGgeGO5TMA4
- github.com/microsoft/Dataaverse-skills
- github.com/microsoft/power-platform-skills

Code and contact

- github.com/readyxrm/irishsummit2026
- nickdoelman.com
- readyxrm.blog

Questions?



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Thank you

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